

(Don't Write anything in this Area)

5.b) Anthropological interpretations of Power

Weber's description of Power entails an ability of an individual to attain his goal despite resistance.

Lundberg's Classification

Internalised
(as member of organisation)

(eg) Black lives movement

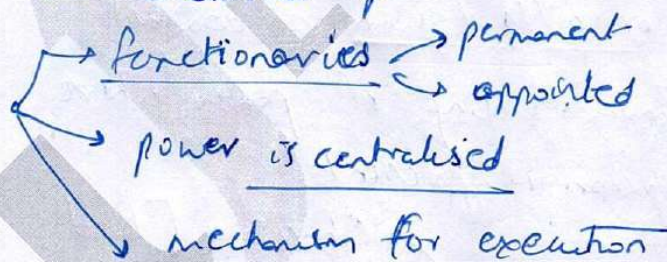
Coercive
(through physical force)

(eg) armed forces

Utilitarian
(as reward mechanism)

(eg) higher rewards for good behaviour

John Rathe (1949) says power must be classified based on whether.



While institutionalised power is authority [Ronald Dahl (Structure of Power)] legitimacy is the key principle determining acceptance.

Features of power

- ① Not institutionalised by nature
- ② Amorphous, not as easily identified as authority
- ③ Present in both Democracy & Autocracy
- ④ Segmentary → distributed
- ⑤ Higher power: greater difficulty is removing said power

Case study In Pottluck, power is described by amount of wealth destroyed, or gifts given as against traditional understanding of power where element of coercion is present

Weber's sources further exemplify how concept of power is amorphous in anthropological context.

- Charisma [Red Indian chief]
- Tradition [God king]
- Legal [primogeniture - Sinai king]